

Freshlancer Overview Document

1. Product Type:

Freelancing marketplace platform tailored specifically for university and college students, connecting them with clients (individuals or companies) seeking affordable freelance services.

2. Target Users:

- Students (with verified university enrollment)
- Clients (startups, small businesses, NGOs, individuals looking for cost-effective services)

3. Problem Statement:

- Students often struggle to find paid work relevant to their field of study.
- Clients often need budget-friendly, skilled freelancers for short-term projects.
- Existing platforms (like Upwork, Freelancer) do not specifically cater to students or entry-level freelancers.

4. Key Features:

Student Side:

- Student registration with proof of enrollment (student ID / certificate).
- Portfolio builder (CV, skills, projects, certificates, intro video).
- Job discovery and smart filtering based on skills.
- Application submission with proposal, budget, and timeline.
- Chat and collaboration tools.
- Secure project delivery and payment release.
- Review system for rating clients.
- Application limits based on subscription:
 - Free tier: Apply to up to 10 projects per month.
 - Premium tier: Unlimited applications with monthly subscription.

Client Side:

- Client registration (individual or company).
- Job posting (title, description, skills, budget, timeline).
- Student directory browsing with filters (skills, rating, availability).

- Invite-to-job or open-for-application mode.
- In-platform messaging.
- Payment escrow and release system.
- Rating and review of students.
- Points-based system for profile access:
 - Clients purchase points/packages to unlock detailed profile data.
 - For each job post, only a limited number of student profiles can be viewed fully (e.g., 3 profiles in Package 1).
 - Other applicants appear anonymized with limited details (skills/summary only).

5. Technical Architecture:

- Frontend: React.js + Tailwind CSS
- Backend: Dot Net/Node.js (Express) / or Django REST Framework
- Database: PostgreSQL (relational)
- Storage: Firebase Storage (for CVs, proof documents, project files)
- Authentication: JWT + Email/OTP

6. Monetization Strategy:

a. From Students:

- Premium accounts with unlimited job applications, profile boost, and analytics.

b. From Clients:

- Points-based revenue model:
 - Clients buy points or subscribe to packages.
 - Points are consumed when unlocking detailed profiles of student applicants.
 - Each package defines how many student profiles can be fully viewed.
 - Additional profile views require more points.
- Limited free access (e.g., see 3 full profiles per job post in basic package).

1. Competitive Advantage:

- Exclusive to students: verified talent with academic background.
- Lower barrier to entry for both sides (affordable for clients, accessible for students).
- Education-aligned gigs: help students build real-world experience.
- Community & mentorship opportunities.

2. Future Enhancements:

- AI-powered proposal suggestions.
- Mentor verification and feedback before submission.
- Gamification: badges, experience points, competitions.
- Local & global internship opportunities.

3. Business Vision:

Empowering the next generation of talent by bridging the gap between academia and the real-world freelance market. Helping students earn, grow, and build a meaningful portfolio before graduation.